

6. ALL 12 TENSES – SIGNAL WORDS & STRUCTURE

Tense Master Chart

PRESENT TENSES

SIMPLE PRESENT

S + V¹ / V¹ + s

always, usually,
often, every day

She plays
cricket.

PRESENT CONTINUOUS

S + am/is/are + V-ing

now, at present

She is playing
cricket.

PRESENT PERFECT

S + have/has + V³

already, just, yet,
since, for

She has played
cricket.

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

S + have/has + been
+ V-ing

since, for, all day

She has been
playing cricket.

PAST TENSES

SIMPLE PAST

S + V²

yesterday, last
night, ago

She played
cricket.

PAST CONTINUOUS

S + was/were + V-ing

while, when

She was playing
cricket.

PAST PERFECT

S + had + V³

before, after

She had played
cricket.

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

S + had + been
+ V-ing

for, since

She had been
playing cricket.

QUICK EXAM NOTE

- Signal words help choose tense
- Verb form decides

FUTURE TENSES

SIMPLE FUTURE

S + will + V¹

tomorrow, next
week

She will play
cricket.

FUTURE CONTINUOUS

S + will be + V-ing

at this time
tomorrow

She will be
playing cricket.

FUTURE PERFECT

S + will have + V³

by tomorrow,
by then

She will have
played cricket.

FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS

S + will have been
+ V-ing

for, since

She will have been
playing cricket.

QUICK EXAM NOTE

- Signal words help choose tense
- Verb form decides tense
- Time logic is more important than rules